

Christian T. Nielsen Garcia

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RESEARCH INTERESTS:

Computer Supported Cooperative Work, Computational Social Science, Human Computer Interaction, Intelligent Decision Support Systems

EDUCATION

09/2023-
Present

The University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA), Los Angeles, CA
PhD Student in Information Studies

- Dissertation: *TBD*
- Key words: Automation, Decentralized Governance, CSCW, Intelligent Decision Support Systems, Collective Intelligence

08/2021-
09/2023

University of Copenhagen (KU), Copenhagen, Denmark
MSc. in Social Data Science

- Thesis:
The crisis of participatory DAOmocracy – Contradictory Mythologies of Cybernetics and Decentralization in Crypto Communities
- Key words: Decentralized eGovernance, Network Science, Natural Language Processing

08/2017-
12/2020

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY
BA in Performing and Media Arts (Emphasis: Digital Media Studies)

- *Magna Cum Laude*,
- Minors: Anthropology, Comparative Literature
- Mellon Mays Undergraduate Fellow

HONORS & AWARDS

08/2026-
Present

Mercatus Fellowship, Mercatus Center (George Mason University)

- Selected for the 2026–2027 fellowship focusing on political economy approaches to institutions, governance, knowledge, AI, and emerging technologies.

02/2026-
07/2026

Alexis de Tocqueville Fellowship, Mercatus Center (George Mason University)

- Selected for competitive fellowship exploring the intersection of Bitcoin, political economy, and philosophy through Hayek, Smith, Tocqueville, and White.
- Participated in research colloquia and interdisciplinary seminars on monetary governance, decentralization, and institutional implications of digital assets.
- Engaged with scholars across political theory, economics, philosophy, and digital asset governance.

01/2026-
Present

Center for Digital Assets Research Award, UC Berkeley (Center for Digital Assets)

- Awarded competitive research funding for work at the intersection of AI, digital twins, blockchain governance, and political theory.
- Funding supports empirical analysis, agent-based governance simulations, and design research on collective decision-making systems in digital communities.

01/2025-
12/2025

AI & Decentralization Innovation Award, Berkeley RDI (Center for Responsible Decentralized Intelligence)

- Awarded competitive research funding for work at the intersection of AI, blockchain governance, and political theory
- Funding supports empirical analysis and design research on decentralized decision-making systems
- Project: *Steering Disagreement in DAOs — Mapping Consensus and Disagreement in Voting Systems*

*Grants and
Fellowships*

2024 -	<u>GSE Predoctoral Research Grant, Soc. Sci. Research Council – Mellon Mays</u> - Awarded competitive funding through the SSRC - Mellon Graduate Initiatives Program for doctoral research - Grant funds allocated to support preliminary research and essential project activities - Project: <u>Critical-Mechanical Fabulation: Can Convolutional Neural Nets (CNNs) help us recover historical artefacts lost to colonialism?</u>
2022-2023	<u>Educational and Professional Fund, University of Copenhagen</u> - Awarded selective research grant for to conduct independent research - Award to be used to fund research project grounded on participatory research with users in gated online communities
2018 - 2020	<u>Mellon Mays Undergraduate Research Fellowship, Cornell University</u> - Fellow in selective national research program - Exposure to advanced scholarly work, independent research project, faculty mentorship, peer-review, academic training workshops, conferences, and research funding - Additional Grants: Research Stipend (2018, 2019, 2020), UChicago SRTP 2020, UCLA WRTP 2019

Achievements and Recognition

F_2022	<u>Certificate Of Achievement, Center for AI and Digital Policy</u>
F_2019, F_2020	<u>Dean's List, Cornell University</u>
F_2020	<u>Marvin Carlson Award (Honorable Mention), Cornell University</u> Essay Title: Gilding Motherhood: The Socio-Economic Restrictions Underlying 'Mildred Pierce'

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Academic Research

08/2023-Present	<u>Mellon Data Justice Graduate Student Researcher, UCLA</u> - Redesigned the Hub's infrastructure into a dynamic platform with consolidated data sources aligned with academic and policy perspectives on data justice. - Delivered guest lectures using the Hub for data collection/visualization and developing user interfaces for personally identifiable data evaluation.
07/2022-11/2022	<u>Co-Curricular Research Project, The University of Copenhagen</u> - Advisor: Professor Hjalmar Bang-Carsen - Title: <i>Topology And Typology In Decentralized Retweet Networks: Exploring The Reproduction Of Blockchain Mythologies In Twitter's Crypto-Communes</i>
07/2022 - 12/2022	<u>Independent Research Project, The University of Copenhagen</u> - REVISED Undergraduate Honors Thesis - Title: <i>Picturing 'Parallel Communities' : Using Computational Ethnography and Networks to visualize Rancierian political philosophy in the digital aesthetics of Denmark's 'Immigrant Ghettoes'</i> - Methods: Netnography, Film Analysis & New Media Cultural Semiotics, Visual Network Analysis, Natural Language Processing, Computer Vision - Theory: Rancierian Political Aesthetics and Alterity, Barthesian Semiotics and Mythology

05/2020 - 08/2020	<u>The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL</u> Summer Research and Writing Program (SRTP) - Awarded grant to attend residential research and writing program - Instructed in persuasive academic writing and socio-cultural theory
06/2019 - 08/2019	<u>The University of California, Los Angeles, Los Angeles, CA</u> Writing & Research Training Program (SRTP) - Awarded grant to attend residential research training program - Instructed in the applications, uses and limitations of digital research tools
01/2018 - 01/2020	<u>MMUF Thesis & Undergraduate Honors Thesis, Cornell University</u> Advisors: Professor Magnus Fiskesjö and Professor Sabine Haenni - Title: <i>Picturing 'Parallel Communities' - Using Rancière to examine myths of difference and belonging in the digital aesthetics of Denmark's 'Immigrant Ghettos'</i> - Methods: Netnography, Qualitative Media Analysis, Film Analysis, New Media Analysis, Political Theory, Critical Theory, Platform Theory
Private Industry Research	07/2022- 01/2023 <u>Flipside Governance, Decentralized (medium.com/flipside-governance)</u> <i>Decentralized Blockchain Governance Research Journal</i> <i>Research Journalist</i>
01/2022 - 08/2022	<u>The Center for AI and Digital Policy, (Remote) Washington, D.C.</u> <i>Independent research organization on US AI & Digital policies and practices</i> <i>Member of Research Group Spring 2022 (Contributor: AIDVI 2023)</i>
05/2017 - 08/2017	<u>Delibera – by ICXCI, Madrid, Spain.</u> <i>Digital platform to structure conversations and promote deliberation</i> <i>Translation, Data Collection, Data Processing</i>

<u>PUBLICATIONS</u>	S_2026	<u>The Geometry of Decision-Making in DAOs: An Information-Theoretic Mapping of Consensus and Disagreement in Decentralized Token Voting</u> - Preprint; under review - Available at SSRN: https://ssrn.com/abstract=6683938 - Author: Christian Nielsen Garcia - Developed from the Berkeley RDI AI & Decentralization Innovation Award Proposes an information-theoretic framework using Rényi entropy-based measures to map consensus, disagreement, and substantively engaged alternatives in DAO token voting across 277 DAOs
Peer-reviewed Research Articles	S_2025	<u>Position: Benchmarking is Broken-Don't Let AI Be Its Own Judge</u> - Accepted in NeurIPS 2025 - Preprint: [LINK] - Co-Authors: Cheng, Z., Wahnig, S., Gupta, R., Alam, S., Abdullahi, T., Ribeiro, J.A., Mir, S., Li, S., Orender, J. and Bahrainian, S.A. Justifies need, and proposes preliminary architecture designs, for a decentralized AI evaluation framework - addressing vulnerabilities in current benchmarks to restore integrity and ensure trustworthy measures of AI progress.

Public Facing Works	S_2024	<u>LA Data Justice Hub</u> • Webpage Data Hub (Includes: Repository, Tutorials, Data Analyses) • Published in UCLA CEC Website • Role: Research and Co-Authorship Principal Investigator, Founder, Author: Dr. M. Bhaumik [Link]
	S_2023	<u>Meditations of Computational Discourse Analysis for DAOs: We read 59,000 DAO forum posts, so you don't have to...</u> • Article • Published in Flipside Governance • Second most-read article on <i>Flipside Governance</i> Editor: Raphael Spannocchi [Link]
	S_2023	<u>Luxembourg AI Country Report.</u> • Policy Report • Forthcoming in: Artificial Intelligence and Democratic Values Index – Center for AI and Digital Policy. • Co-author: Conciacig, C. (Accepted: AIDVI 2023) [Link]
CONFERENCES	06/2026 upcoming	<u>Teaching & Learning Center Symposium: <i>Adapting Instruction in the Age of AI</i>, UCLA</u> • Panel: <i>Ethics, Integrity, & Equity: What Do We Gain & Lose with GenAI in Higher Ed?</i> • Contributing perspective on AI, collective intelligence, and governance in sociotechnical systems • University-wide symposium featuring keynote by Terence Tao and panels across disciplines
Panelist		
Panelist	05/2026	<u>Building AI for Classical Liberal Alignment,</u> <i>Institute for Humane Studies, George Mason University / Positive AI Labs</i> • Invited to an honorarium-supported scholarly convening on pluralistic AI alignment, moral reasoning, humane judgment, and AI evaluation frameworks. • Participated in interdisciplinary discussion with scholars and graduate researchers across the social sciences and humanities.
Founder	10/2023	<u>Graduate Conference Social Data Science, University of Copenhagen</u> • Founder, Director, and Moderator for inaugural conference • Researchers from The University of Copenhagen, Oxford University, London School of Economics, Lund University, and UCLA.
Panelist	08/2020	<u>SRTP Research Symposium, University of Chicago (REMOTE)</u> • Panel Name: <i>Media & Globalization: Transnational and Diasporic Perspectives</i> • Presentation Title: <i>Picturing 'Parallel Communities': Myths of difference and belonging in the digital aesthetics of Denmark's 'Immigrant Ghettoes'</i>
	08/2019	<u>WRTP Research Symposium, University of California, Los Angeles</u> • Panel Name: <i>Data & Media Studies</i> Presentation Title: <i>Digital Mythologies and Xenophobia in Denmark: Using Roland Barthes to examine the political aesthetics of Denmark's Digital Ghetos</i>
Attendee	11/2019	<u>Mid-Atlantic Regional Conference, Swarthmore College</u>
	03/2018	<u>Mid-Atlantic Regional Conference, University of Pennsylvania</u>

Posters	F_2022	<u>Talking Governance: Epistemic Network Analysis and Discursive Governance in Decentralized Blockchain Organizations</u> Presented at the 2022 International Conference on Quantitative Ethnography (ICQE) Nielsen Garcia 2022.
<u>TEACHING EXPERIENCE</u>	W_2026	<u>Teaching Assistant, UCLA</u> <i>Course: INF STD 20 – Digital Cultures and Societies</i> <i>Responsibilities: Support instruction in a large interdisciplinary undergraduate course on technology, media, and society. Lead discussion sections and guest lectures; facilitate critical analysis of readings on AI, platforms, power, and information institutions; advise and evaluate group midterm projects and individual response papers; hold weekly office hours; assist with course administration, assessment, and in-class exams.</i>
	F_2025	<u>Guest Lecture, UCLA</u> <i>Course Name: Digital Humanities (DGT HUM) M121 - Race, Gender, and Data</i> <i>Responsibilities: Introduce students to Data Analysis for Social Research, write and guide students through python tutorial to introduce APIs, data cleaning, analysis and data viz.</i>
	W_2024	<u>Guest Lecture, UCLA</u> <i>Course Name: Data, Justice, and Society (Freshman Cluster)</i> <i>Responsibilities: Introduce Students to Data Analysis for Social Research. Guide students through intro to Tableau and review development and critique of “Digital Divide” Research.</i>
	F_2024	<u>Guest Lecture, UCLA</u> <i>Course Name: Digital Humanities (DGT HUM) M121 - Race, Gender, and Data</i> <i>Responsibilities: Introduce students to Data Analysis for Social Research, write and guide students through python tutorial to introduce APIs, data cleaning, analysis and data viz.</i>
	F_2022	<u>Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Copenhagen</u> <i>Course Name: Social Data Analysis</i> <i>Responsibilities: Lead Discussion Section (6hrs/week), Provide Feedback on Assignments</i>
	S_2023	<u>Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Copenhagen</u> <i>Course Name: Advanced Social Data Science II</i> <i>Responsibilities: Lead Discussion Section (6hrs/week), Prepare Problem Set Solutions, Provide Feedback on Problem Sets</i>
<u>CREATIVE WORKS</u>	12/2020	<u>Filmmaker (Director of Video Essay):</u> <u>Title: Crosswinds: Catalogues of Covid</u> (Virtual) Screening: <i>Off-Camps/On-Screen: Cornell Life in the Time of COVID-19</i> - Proposed, filmed, and edited documentary as part of Documentary Film course led by Professor Jefferey Palmer - Used ethnographic interviews to examine: - How the disruptive properties of a global pandemic affect the material and labor conditions of university students Logline: Recent graduates contend with the risk of fulfilling their passions amidst an uncertain future in 2020
<u>SERVICE</u>	08/2026-Present	<u>Graduate Student Representative, Data Governance Committee</u> <u>University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)</u> Appointed by the Graduate Students Association to advise campus-wide governance of institutional data, focusing on access, classification, privacy, security, and stewardship.

2023- Present	<u>Board Member, Cornellians in Spain (Cornell University Alumni Network)</u> • Participate in governance of alumni organization focused on strengthening ties between Cornell University and Spain-based alumni and students • Contribute to strategic discussions on community initiatives, outreach, and treasury planning • Support programming including student send-offs and alumni engagement events • Engage in biannual board meetings to guide organizational direction
10/2021 – 12/2022	<u>Vice-Chair, Board of Studies for the MSc in Social Data Science</u> <u>The University of Copenhagen</u> • Co-led academic governance body responsible for curriculum design, course structure, and quality assurance for the MSc in Social Data Science • Evaluated teaching and contributed to iterative improvements in course design and program structure • Participated in formal decision-making on student petitions, including credit transfer and exemptions • Coordinated with faculty and administration across departments (Economics, Sociology, Anthropology, Political Science) • Contributed to policy discussions on data science education and interdisciplinary training • Participated in recurring governance meetings (6 per year) shaping program direction
07/2022	<u>UCLA MMUF WRTP Alumni Colloquium, UCLA (Virtual)</u>
05/2018 – 08/2018	<u>Fundación Gomaespuma NGO,</u> <u>Matale & Batticaloa, Sri Lanka</u> • Designed and led performance ethnography workshops at two orphanages serving Tamil and Sinhalese communities • Guided participants in storytelling, collaborative performance, and reflection on identity, conflict, and community
01/2017 – 05/2017	<u>Kensal Library, The Royal Borough of Kensington and Chelsea</u> <u>London, United Kingdom</u>

**LINGUISTIC
AND
TECHNICAL
SKILLS**

Written and Spoken Languages

- Native fluency in English and Spanish
- Advanced Fluency in Danish
- Intermediate Fluency in Portuguese
- Reading knowledge and basic speech in Catalan and Swedish

Programming Languages

- Fluent in Python, SQL, Git
- Familiarity with R, C, C++ (SL), HTML, CSS, Go

Design and Editing Software

- Sound Design
ProTools (Avid), Audition (Adobe)
- Film and Video:
Premiere Pro

Data Analysis Software and Skills

Collection and Cleaning

- API Design
- Large Scale Data Mining & Scraping
- Processing

Social Network Analysis

- Gephi
- NetworkX
- Neo4j

Data Analysis

- ML, DL
(Regression Analysis, NLP, Computer Vision, Neural Nets, etc.)
- Tableau (Data Analysis, Representation)
- NetLogo (Agent-Based Modelling)

